

GEOGRAPHY

INDIAN GEOGRAPHY



INDIAN NATURAL VEGETATION

MODULE - 1

VEGETATION OF INDIA

- **TYPES OF FORESTS**



NATURAL VEGETATION



- 1** Natural Vegetation refers to a plant community that has been left undisturbed over a long time, so as to allow its individual species to adjust themselves to climate and soil conditions as fully as possible.
- 2** India is a land of great variety of natural vegetation.
- 3** Himalayan heights are marked with temperate vegetation, the Western Ghats and the Andaman Nicobar Islands have tropical rain forests, the deltaic regions have tropical forests and mangroves, the desert and semi desert areas of Rajasthan are known for cactii, a wide variety of bushes and thorny vegetation.
- 4** Depending upon the variations in the climate and the soil, the vegetation of India changes from one region to another.
- 5** On the basis of certain common features the vegetation of India are broadly divided into
 - 1)** Tropical Evergreen and Semi Evergreen forests
 - 2)** Tropical Deciduous forests
 - 3)** Tropical Thorn forests
 - 4)** Montane forests
 - 5)** Littoral and Swamp forests.



NATURAL VEGETATION

FACTORS AFFECTING VEGETATION



**Important climatic factors-
Temperature and rainfall**

- 1** The geographical factors which influence natural vegetation include climate, soil and topography.
- 2** The main climatic factors are rainfall and temperature.
- 3** The seasonal rainfall regime, the length of dry season and its relation to the march of temperature, are also important.
- 4** The amount of annual rainfall has a great bearing on the type of vegetation.



NATURAL VEGETATION

FACTORS AFFECTING VEGETATION



5 Areas receiving 200 cm or more rainfall per annum have stands of evergreen rain forests while monsoon deciduous forests dominate in area with rainfall between 100 and 200 cm.

6 In areas having 50 to 100 cm rainfall there are drier deciduous or tropical savannah grading into open thorny scrub vegetation.

7 While those with less than 50 cm rainfall have only dry thorny scrub and low open bush merging into semi desert.

8 In higher altitudes of the Himalayas and the hills of the Peninsula at elevation of more than 900 metre above sea level, temperature plays a more important role.



NATURAL VEGETATION

FACTORS AFFECTING VEGETATION



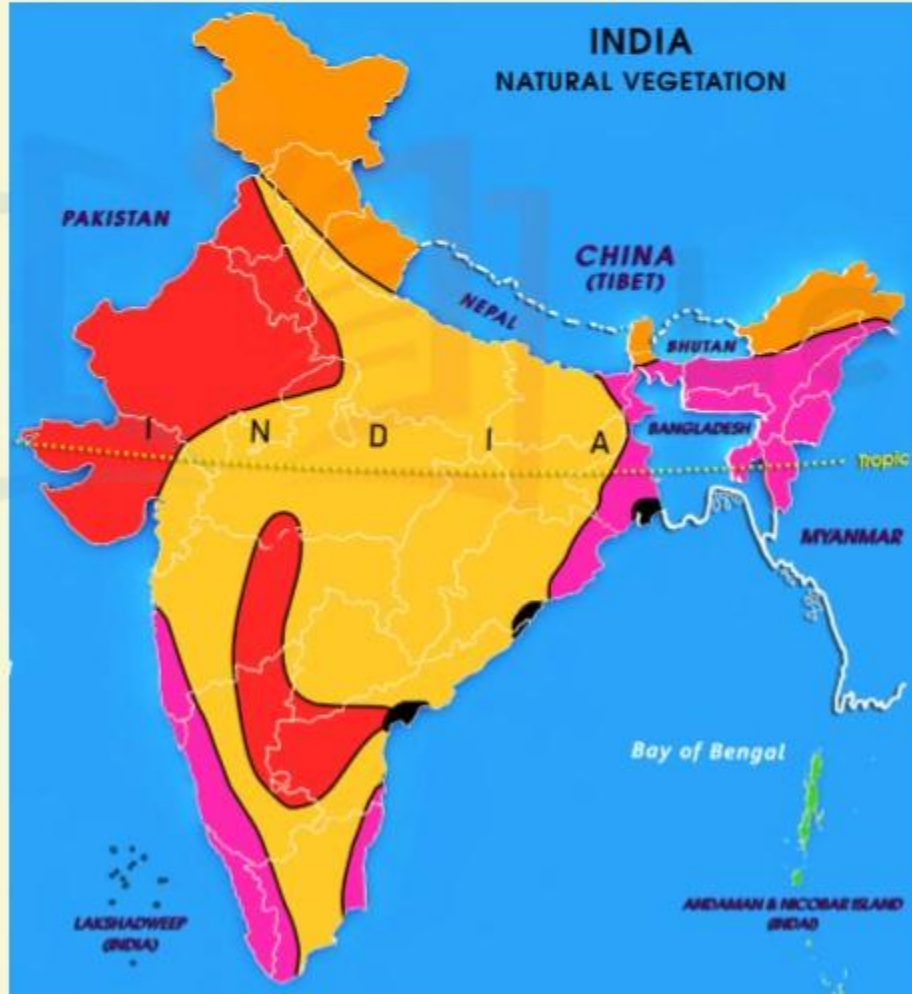
Mangroves in India

- 9** As the temperature falls with altitude in the Himalayan region the vegetal cover changes from **tropical to sub-tropical, temperate and finally alpine**.
- 10** Changes in soil conditions have given birth to different types of vegetation in different parts of the country.
- 11** Mangrove forests, swamp forests, and beach and sandy coastal forests are some of the outstanding examples of influence of soil on natural vegetation.
- 12** Topography in the narrow sense is responsible for certain minor types e.g. alpine flora, tidal forests, etc.

TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL EVERGREEN AND SEMI-EVERGREEN FORESTS

TYPE NO. 1

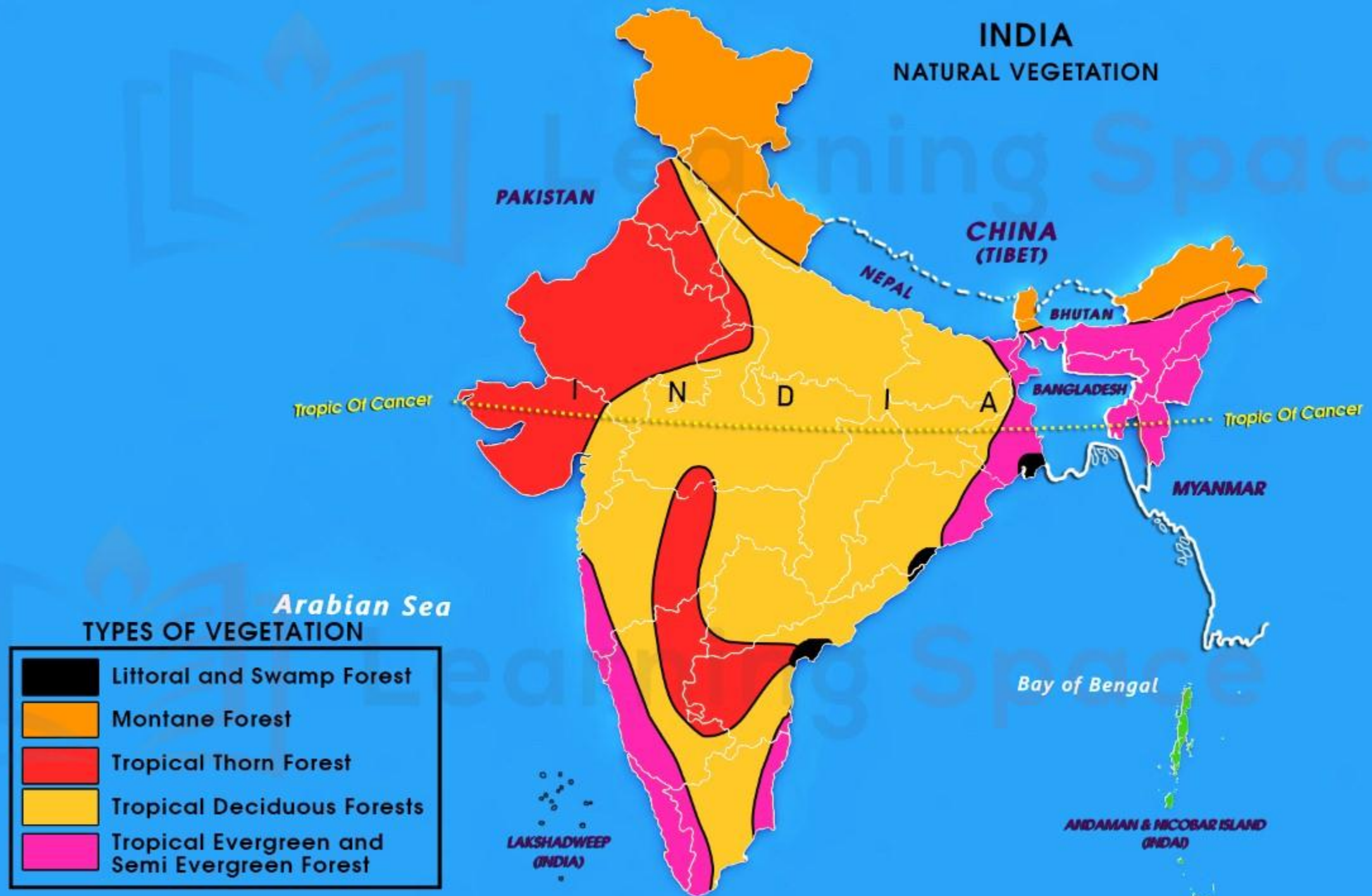


1 These forests are found in the western slope of the Western Ghats, hills of the northeastern region and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

2 They are found in warm and humid areas with an annual precipitation of over 200 cm and mean annual temperature above 22°C.

3 Tropical evergreen forests are well stratified, with layers closer to the ground and are covered with shrubs and creepers, with short structured trees followed by tall variety of trees.

INDIA NATURAL VEGETATION



TYPE NO. 1



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL EVERGREEN AND SEMI-EVERGREEN FORESTS



4 In these forests, trees reach great heights up to 60 m or above.

5 There is no definite time for trees to shed their leaves, flowering and fruition.

6 As such these forests appear green all the year round.

7 Species found in these forests include rosewood, mahogany, aini, ebony, etc.

8 The semi evergreen forests are found in the less rainy parts of these regions. Such forests have a mixture of evergreen and moist deciduous trees.

9 The undergrowing climbers provide an evergreen character to these forests.

10 Main species of semi-evergreen type are white cedar, hollock and kail.

TYPE NO. 1



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL EVERGREEN AND SEMI-EVERGREEN FORESTS



The present day pine trees of Garhwal

11 The British were aware of the economic value of the forests in India, hence, large scale exploitation of these forests was started.

12 The structure of forests was also changed. The oak forests in Garhwal and Kumaon were replaced by pine (chirs) which was needed to lay railway lines.

FURTHER REFERENCE

<https://www.downtoearth.org.in/blog/forests/why-cutting-down-chirpine-is-not-a-solution-to-uttarakhand-forest-fires-51178>

Why cutting down Chirpine is not a solution to Uttarakhand forest fires

TYPE NO. 1



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL EVERGREEN AND SEMI-EVERGREEN FORESTS



13 Forests were also cleared for introducing plantations of tea, rubber and coffee.

14 The British also used **timber** for construction activities as it acts as an insulator of heat.

15 The protectional use of forests was, thus, replaced by **commercial use**.

TYPE NO. 1



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL EVERGREEN AND SEMI-EVERGREEN FORESTS



TABLE FOR QUICK REVISION

TABLE FOR QUICK REVISION	
Climate	Rainfall > 200cm, temperature > 22 ⁰ C
Area	Western slope of Western Ghats, North-eastern region, Andaman and Nicobar
Unique characteristics	Evergreen trees; thick canopy; growth of epiphytes; Absence of pure stands.

TYPE NO. 2



TYPES OF FORESTS

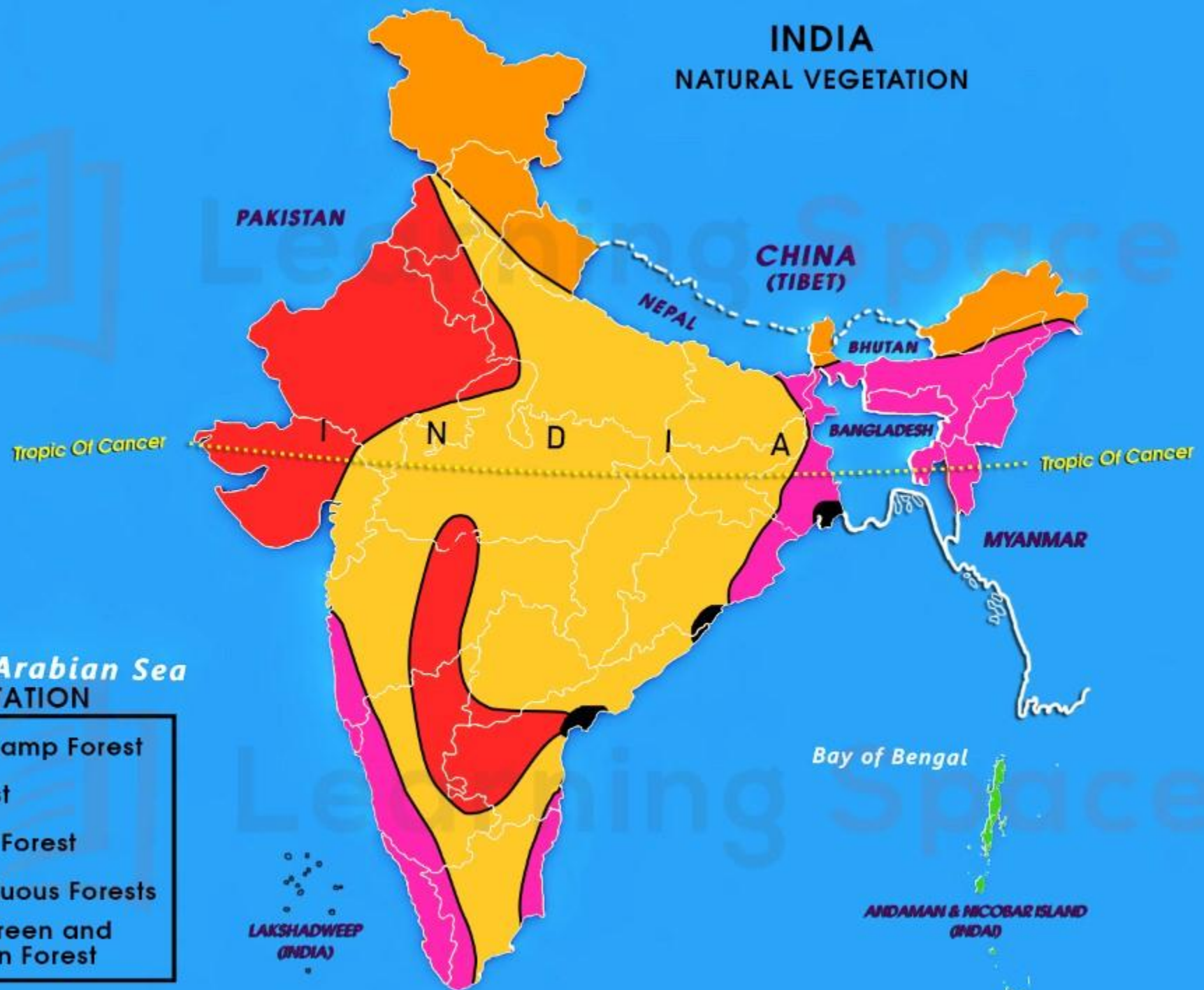
TROPICAL DECIDUOUS FORESTS



- 1 These are the most widespread forests in India.
- 2 They are also called the **monsoon forests**.
- 3 They spread over regions which receive rainfall **between 70-200 cm**.
- 4 On the basis of the availability of water, these forests are further divided into **moist and dry deciduous**.

INDIA

NATURAL VEGETATION



TYPES OF VEGETATION

- Littoral and Swamp Forest
- Montane Forest
- Tropical Thorn Forest
- Tropical Deciduous Forests
- Tropical Evergreen and Semi Evergreen Forest

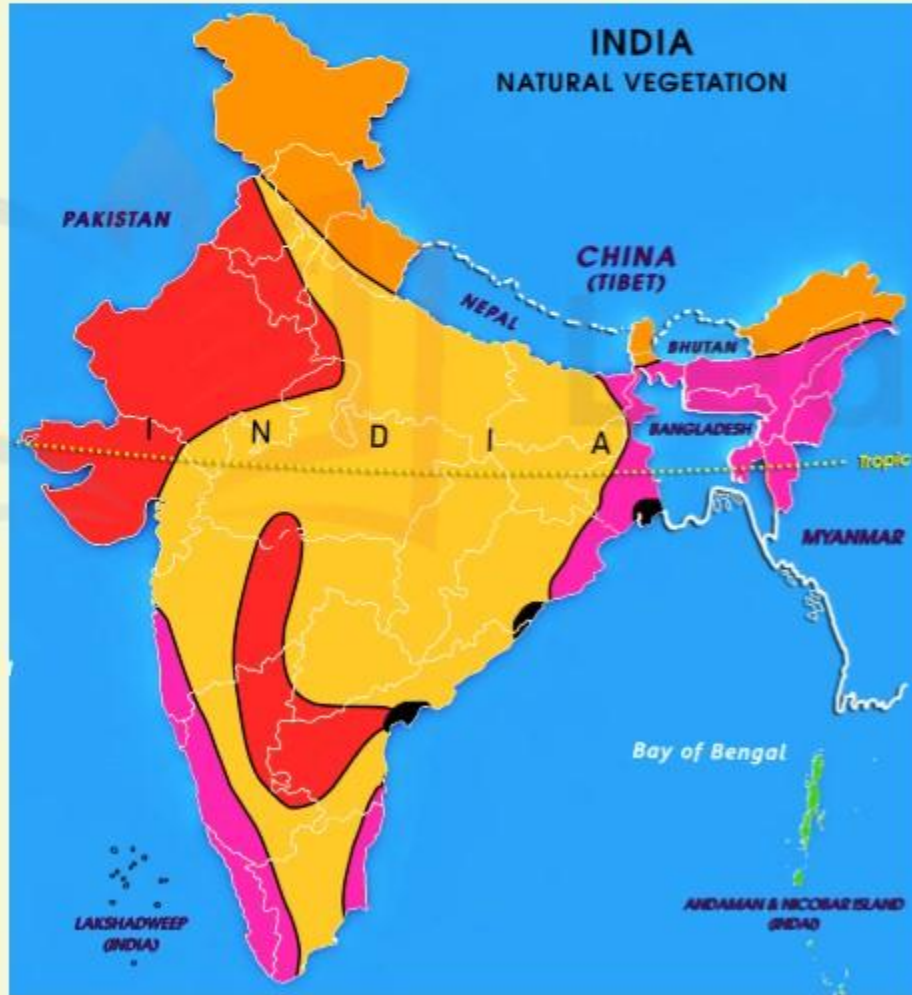
TYPE NO. 2



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL DECIDUOUS FORESTS

MOIST DECIDUOUS FORESTS



- 1 The Moist deciduous forests are more pronounced in the regions which record **rainfall between 100-200 cm.**
- 2 These forests are found in the northeastern states along the foothills of Himalayas, eastern slopes of the Western Ghats and Orissa.
- 3 Teak, sal, shisham, hurra, mahua, amla, semul, kusum, and sandalwood etc. are the main species of these forests.

TYPE NO. 2**TYPES OF FORESTS****TROPICAL DECIDUOUS
FORESTS****MOIST DECIDUOUS FORESTS****TABLE FOR QUICK REVISION**

Climate	Rainfall=100-200cm, temperature $\cong 27^{\circ}\text{C}$
Area	Foothills of Himalayas, Eastern slope of Western Ghats, Odisha
Unique characteristics	Shedding of leaves: valuable timber like teak, sal

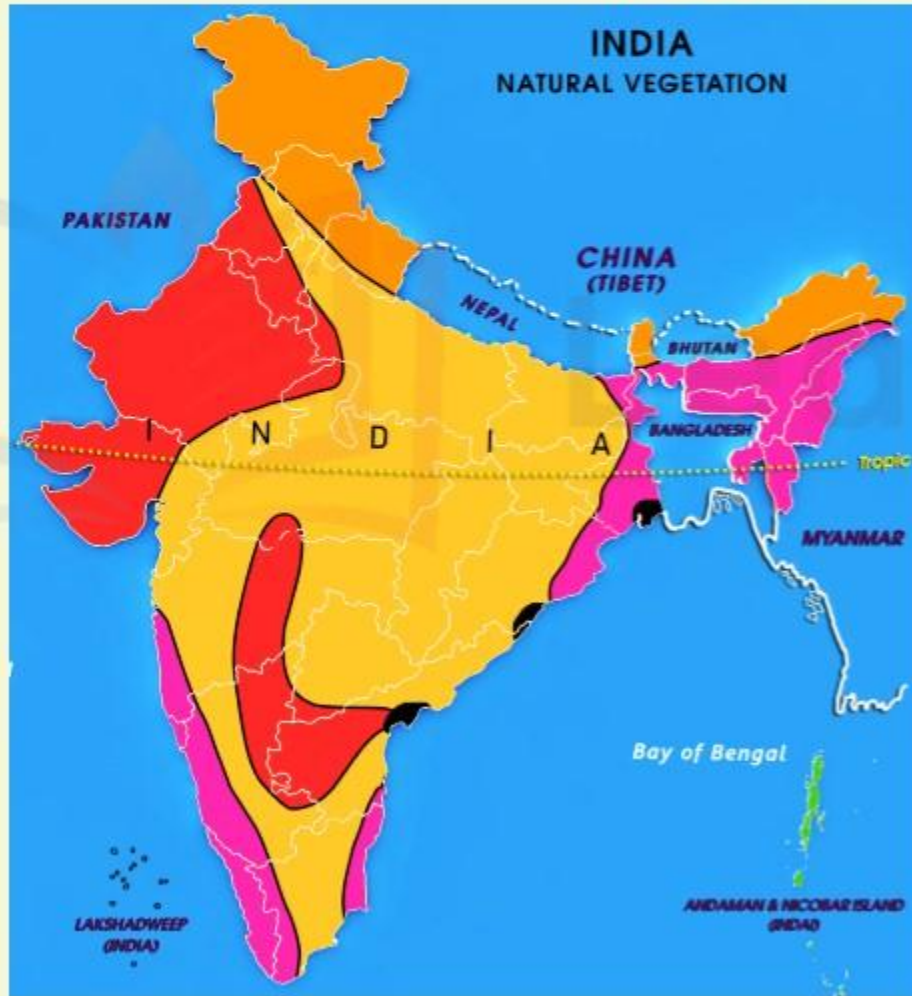
TYPE NO. 2



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL DECIDUOUS FORESTS

DRY DECIDUOUS FORESTS



- 1 Dry deciduous forest covers vast areas of the country, where rainfall ranges between 70 -100 cm.
- 2 On the wetter margins, it has a transition to the moist deciduous, while on the drier margins to thorn forests.
- 3 These forests are found in rainier areas of the Peninsula and the plains of Uttar Pradesh and Bihar.

TYPE NO. 2



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL DECIDUOUS FORESTS

DRY DECIDUOUS FORESTS



Tendu tree whose leaves are wrapped around tobacco to make the beedi.

4 In the higher rainfall regions of the Peninsular plateau and the northern Indian plain, these forests have a parkland landscape with open stretches in which trees get interspersed with patches of grass are common.

5 As the dry season begins, the trees shed their leaves completely and the forest appears like a vast grassland with naked trees all around.

6 Tendu, palas, amaltas, khair, axlewood, bel are the common trees of these forests.

TYPE NO. 2



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL DECIDUOUS FORESTS

DRY DECIDUOUS FORESTS



Above- Khair tree

On the left side- Amaltas tree

TYPE NO. 2



TYPES OF FORESTS

TROPICAL DECIDUOUS FORESTS

DRY DECIDUOUS FORESTS



TABLE FOR QUICK REVISION

TABLE FOR QUICK REVISION	
Climate	Rainfall= 70-100 cm, temperature $\cong 27^{\circ}\text{C}$
Area	Rainier parts of Peninsula, plains of UP, Bihar etc.
Unique characteristics	Transitional type of forests; Prone to overgrazing, cleared for agriculture, forest fires etc.

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